



Ryan Skeels

🌐 thoughtwindows.com
(cv & portfolio)

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📍 Denver, Colorado

Program & Operations Management

- Cross-functional program leadership
- Process design & improvement
- Change management & tool adoption
- SOP & documentation development
- Vendor & stakeholder management
- Event & logistics operations
- Financial & budget oversight (~\$500K)
- Regulatory compliance & risk management

Tools

- Slack (administered)
- Google Workspace (Sheets, Docs, Drive, Calendar)
- QuickBooks
- Adobe Illustrator & Photoshop
- Canva

AI in Practice

- Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini
- Documentation & summarization
- Research & workflow acceleration

Technical

- Web Accessibility Testing (DHS Trusted Tester / WCAG)
- HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, Node.js, SQL
- Alt-text, ARIA, semantic HTML, screen reader testing

Language

- English (Native)
- Spanish (B1 - B2)

Operations leader with 15+ years designing and leading programs across small business, public health, and field operations. Known for bringing structure to ambiguous environments — building systems, improving workflows, and enabling teams to operate efficiently and independently. Experienced in cross-functional coordination, process design, tool implementation, and change management. Actively developing skills in web development and accessibility.

Selected Programs & Operational Impact

COVID-19 Operational Pivot

Led overnight transition from 95% over-the-bar sales to full online ordering and to-go operation. Coordinated tool integration, vendor communication, and staff adoption in real time under rapidly changing conditions. Emerged with team intact, expanded product footprint, and larger customer base.

POS & Time-Tracking System Implementation

Led evaluation, rollout, and staff adoption of two successive POS systems and a new time-tracking platform. Managed resistance to change, coordinated training, and integrated new tools with online ordering workflows — improving operational alignment across in-person and digital channels.

Operational Documentation & Systems Program

Designed SOPs, checklists, and tiered Google Drive architecture enabling independent team execution across scheduling, onboarding, production, and compliance — reducing reliance on owner intervention and improving consistency.

Production Workflow Management System

Built and managed tracking systems for 12+ concurrent production workflows across independent daily schedules. Maintained operational continuity through daily coordination, adjustment, and cross-team alignment in a constraint-heavy environment.

Experience

Co-Owner | Co-Founder | Operations Manager

Baere Brewing Company | Denver, CO | 2012 - 2023

*- Featured -
most relevant to this role*

- Led end-to-end operations for a 10-person production and hospitality business, designing programs and systems that enabled the organization to scale while maintaining consistency, quality, and compliance
- Managed a multi-track production system with 12+ concurrent workflows, each requiring daily tracking, adjustment, and cross-team coordination
- Led implementation of two successive POS systems and a new time-tracking platform — managing rollout, staff training, and adoption; navigated resistance and drove successful transition
- Spearheaded COVID-19 operational pivot: launched online ordering and new fulfillment workflows, integrated tools, and coordinated across vendors, staff, and evolving regulatory requirements
- Built and maintained operational tracking systems (Google Sheets, QuickBooks) for production scheduling, financials, and inventory — improving visibility and decision-making
- Administered Slack as the team's primary communication platform from 2016, managing channels, workflows, and information flow across staff and operations
- Designed SOPs, checklists, and shared documentation systems enabling independent team execution and reducing operational friction
- Planned and executed recurring large-scale public events, managing logistics, vendors, staffing, and timelines
- Oversaw ~\$500K annual budget including payroll, accounting, tax compliance, and financial reporting

Business Sale & Relocation to Spain

March 2023 - Present

- Managed sale and operational handover of Baere Brewing Company; relocated family to Valencia, Spain for a planned period of language immersion and cross-cultural experience

Content Designer & Visual Communications Specialist

Andrea Moore Arts / Special Olympics International projects / June 2024 - Present

- Created a cohesive icon library aligned with disability-related vocabulary and curated a visual public health timeline aligned with accessibility standards
- Designed presentation materials and educational slide decks focused on navigating healthcare systems for individuals with developmental disabilities and their allies, including alt-text for images to support screen reader compatibility

English Language Teacher & Tutor

CEIP San Clemente & Online / Sedaví, Valencia, Spain / October 2024 - Present

- Facilitate bilingual instruction within Spanish-led classrooms, adapting materials across age groups.
- Used AI tools (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini) to streamline lesson planning and content generation.

Environmental Health Investigator II

City of Denver Public Health & Environment / Denver, CO / 2012 - 2014

- Managed a self-directed inspection program, tracking compliance deadlines, follow-ups, and enforcement actions across a large facility portfolio with no administrative support
- Advised business owners on building systems of standard procedures to simultaneously improve operations and mitigate public health risks
- Authored detailed inspection reports and enforcement documentation to support corrective action and legal proceedings

Natural Resource Specialist

Jefferson County Open Space / Golden, CO / 2008 - 2012

- Supervised and coordinated seasonal field crews of 6–8 across multiple concurrent projects, balancing work site requirements, team needs, and individual strengths
- Planned, designed, executed, and reported on large-scale forest restoration and habitat conservation projects across public lands
- Developed operational procedures and training materials to improve internal program efficiency and compliance

Education

Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO
B.A. Science - Forest Management / 2006

International TEFL Academy, Chicago, IL - Online
Teaching English as a Foreign Language Certification / 2023

Taronja Spanish Language School, Valencia, Spain
Continued Learning / 2023 - 2024

La Pagoda Spanish Language School, Valencia, Spain
Continued Learning / 2024 - 2025

Technology

Trusted Tester, Online
DHS Web Accessibility Testing Certification / June 2025

Full Stack Javascript Course, Online
Self-led Web Development Curriculum / 2025 - Present